

Day of the Girl 2023

Supporting Girls and Women in Underprivileged Communities — in Partnership with Sisters By Heart Global Initiative

In celebration of the International Day of the Girl 2023, GDGF partnered with Sisters By Heart Global Initiative to deliver two complementary interventions: a financial contribution of ₦50,000 toward a menstrual hygiene management and reusable pad-making training in Kwara State, and the purchase of a mixing machine for Ms. Anino — a young woman living with disability in Warri, Delta State — to support her pastry and cake-making business.

Organisation	Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF)
Partner	Sisters By Heart Global Initiative
Date	October 11, 2023 — International Day of the Girl
Component 1	₦50,000 financial contribution to Sisters By Heart's MHM training and reusable pad-making programme — Kwara State
Component 2	Mixing machine donated to Ms. Anino — young woman living with disability, pastry/cake business, Warri, Delta State
States Reached	Kwara State (North-Central) · Delta State (South-South)
Documentation	Video documentation of activities available as means of verification

₦50K

GDGF Financial Contribution

2

States (Kwara + Delta)

1

Business Supported

1

Partner Organisation

Overview

In celebration of the International Day of the Girl on October 11, 2023, Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF) partnered with Sisters By Heart Global Initiative to support girls and women from underprivileged communities across selected locations in Nigeria. The initiative comprised two complementary interventions reflecting GDGF's belief in uplifting others through practical, community-rooted action.

The first component was a financial contribution of ₦50,000 toward Sisters By Heart's menstrual hygiene management programme in Kwara State — including hands-on sessions on making reusable period pads and other practical skills for girls. The second was a direct business intervention in Warri, Delta State: the purchase of a mixing machine for Ms. Anino, a young woman living with disability whose pastry and cake-making business was limited by the absence of essential equipment.

GDGF's partnership model: *'We believe in the power of uplifting others, and we demonstrate this by collaborating with like-minded organisations to create meaningful impact, especially for women and girls.' This initiative embodied that principle — GDGF enabled and amplified the work of a trusted partner where it could do the most good.*

About the Partnership

Sisters By Heart Global Initiative is a continuing GDGF partner. Their chapter previously served as GDGF's Abuja implementing partner during the 2020–2021 Bloody Cup Campaign. The Day of the Girl 2023 collaboration deepened that relationship, with GDGF providing ₦50,000 to back Sisters By Heart's own Kwara State menstrual health programme.

A continuing partnership: *Sisters By Heart facilitated menstrual cup distribution for GDGF in Abuja during the Bloody Cup Campaign (2020–2021). By financially supporting their Day of the Girl programme in Kwara State in 2023, GDGF continued to invest in a trusted partner's capacity to deliver across North-Central Nigeria.*

Component 1 — MHM Training and Reusable Pad Making, Kwara State

GDGF contributed ₦50,000 to Sisters By Heart Global Initiative to support their menstrual hygiene management programme in Kwara State. Sisters By Heart led the programme as the implementing organisation; GDGF's contribution enabled its delivery.

- Menstrual hygiene management education — covering menstrual health, hygiene practices, and normalisation of periods in community settings
- Hands-on training in making reusable period pads — equipping girls with the practical skill to produce their own sustainable menstrual products
- Additional practical skills sessions — building broader confidence and knowledge among participating girls

Why reusable pad making matters: *Teaching girls to make their own reusable pads is among the most sustainable menstrual health interventions available — eliminating ongoing cost, producing a product lasting up to two years, and building a transferable skill. This aligns directly with GDGF's strategic shift toward sustainable menstrual solutions established through the 2020–2021 Bloody Cup Campaign.*

Video documentation of the Kwara State programme is available as a means of verification for this initiative.

Component 2 — Business Support: Ms. Anino, Warri, Delta State

GDGF purchased a mixing machine for Ms. Anino — a young woman living with disability based in Warri, Delta State — to support and grow her pastry and cake-making business. The machine addressed a specific equipment gap that was constraining her production capacity and therefore her income.

Ms. Anino's story: *A young female entrepreneur living with disability in Warri, Delta State, Ms. Anino runs a pastry and cake-making business. Without a mixing machine, her production was limited in both quality and volume. GDGF's intervention removed that barrier directly — investing in her capacity and her economic independence on the International Day of the Girl.*

This intervention reflects core GDGF values simultaneously: female entrepreneurship support, disability inclusion, and economic empowerment through targeted, practical intervention rather than information alone.

On disability inclusion: *Women living with disabilities face compounded barriers to economic participation that most development programmes fail to address specifically. Ms. Anino's inclusion in this initiative was a deliberate choice to reach the most marginalised — not merely the most accessible.*

Outcomes and Impact

Reusable pad-making skills transferred to girls in Kwara State

Girls who participated gained a practical, lasting skill — the ability to make their own reusable menstrual pads — supported by GDGF's ₦50,000 contribution.

Menstrual health stigma addressed

The MHM education component created community space for girls to discuss menstruation openly, normalising periods in a setting where menstrual taboos remain prevalent.

Ms. Anino's business capacity directly strengthened

The mixing machine donation increased Ms. Anino's production capacity — enabling her to make more products and grow her income and economic independence in Warri.

Disability inclusion in economic empowerment

By specifically identifying and supporting a young woman living with disability, GDGF demonstrated a commitment to reaching the most marginalised.

Two-state reach through partnership

A single Day of the Girl initiative reached Kwara State (North-Central) and Delta State (South-South) — through partnership rather than solo delivery.

Durable partnership with Sisters By Heart sustained

The continued collaboration — from the Bloody Cup Campaign in 2020–2021 to Day of the Girl 2023 — reflects a trust-based organisational relationship producing impact across multiple years.

Initiative Summary

Category	Details
Date	October 11, 2023 — International Day of the Girl
Partner	Sisters By Heart Global Initiative
GDGF financial contribution	■50,000 toward Component 1
Component 1	MHM training and reusable pad making — Kwara State
Component 1 lead	Sisters By Heart (GDGF provided ■50,000 financial support)
Component 2	Mixing machine for Ms. Anino's pastry business — Warri, Delta State
Component 2 beneficiary	Ms. Anino — young woman living with disability, cake/pastry entrepreneur
States reached	Kwara State · Delta State
Documentation	Video of activities available
Prior partnership	Sisters By Heart: Abuja implementing partner, Bloody Cup Campaign 2020–2021

Learning and Recommendations

The ■50,000 financial contribution model — backing a trusted partner's own programme — is a low-overhead, high-impact approach that allows GDGF to extend reach without managing full implementation. Documenting the exact outcomes of partner-led programmes (participant numbers, impact data) requires a formal reporting agreement with the partner at the outset.

The reusable pad-making component should be incorporated as a standard feature of GDGF's menstrual health programming going forward — it produces a skill and an asset, not just knowledge.

The business support model for Ms. Anino — identifying a specific equipment need and purchasing directly — is verifiable, targeted, and deeply meaningful. Future programmes should build a structured pipeline for identifying women entrepreneurs living with disability for similar support.

Requesting a written activity report from Sisters By Heart for the Kwara State MHM programme would strengthen the documentation for this initiative and set a standard for all future partner-supported activities.

Partners and Acknowledgements

- Sisters By Heart Global Initiative — for leading the Kwara State MHM programme and continuing a trusted multi-year partnership with GDGF
- Ms. Anino, Warri, Delta State — for her entrepreneurship and resilience

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- The girls who participated in the Kwara State MHM and reusable pad-making sessions